

II. EMPIRICAL TRENDS IN THE ALLOCATION OF TIME

II.A. Data

To document the trends in the allocation of time over the last forty years, we link five major time-use surveys: 1965–1966 America's Use of Time; 1975–1976 Time Use in Economics and Social Accounts; 1985 Americans' Use of Time; 1992–1994 National Human Activity Pattern Survey; and the 2003 American Time Use Survey.⁴ The data in the Appendix and Table I describe these surveys in detail. All data and programs used to create the results in this paper are available on the authors' websites. In this section, we characterize four major uses of time: market work, nonmarket production, child care, and leisure.